

LUMEN TECHNOLOGIES · AI VISIBILITY ANALYSIS

Lumen Is Building the Backbone for AI. AI Doesn't Know It Yet.

AI assistants now form the first impression of a company for the buyers, reporters and candidates who ask them — often before a salesperson or a journalist ever does. A first look at **how those assistants interpret Lumen** in the enterprise fiber, edge and security conversation.

A communications-grade take on AI visibility — not a marketing dashboard. Bespoke analysis from Innate C3, with a small live preview of Lumen's own results inside. The figures here are an **illustrative 50-answer snapshot**, meant to show what the analysis surfaces — not a verdict.

THE SHIFT

AI Assistants Are Now a Primary Audience

The CIOs, network architects, analysts and reporters who shape Lumen's reputation increasingly ask an AI assistant first — **ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Gemini, Perplexity and the crawlers behind them** — and act on the answer it hands back. Every category Lumen competes in is already being consumed, summarized and relayed by machines, whether or not Lumen is in the answer. **The question for a communications team: is Lumen's story written and structured to be found by that audience?**

57.5%

of requests for web content are now bots & AI agents — machines passed humans in June 2026, ahead of forecast

1.8B

people have used AI tools worldwide

58%

have replaced search with AI for recommendations

~60%

of Google searches now end without a click

25%

projected drop in traditional search volume by 2026

Sources: Cloudflare Radar, June 2026 (via Forbes) · Menlo Ventures, *2025: The State of Consumer AI* · Capgemini (Jan 2025) · SparkToro, 2024 Zero-Click Study · Gartner (Feb 2024). Lumen's own sample follows on the next pages.

In a B2B category decided by credibility, what the AI surfaces is becoming the buyer's shortlist — owned + earned, measured.

WHY THIS IS DIFFERENT

A Communications Opportunity, Not an SEO One

When an assistant assembles its answer on *"who provides the best enterprise fiber, edge and security for large businesses?"*, it isn't parsing keywords and meta tags. It's discovering, parsing and quoting sources — and every one is communications territory:

01

Owned narrative signals

Whether Lumen's own storytelling — the newsroom, thought leadership, the AI-infrastructure and Private Connectivity Fabric narrative — is open, structured and quotable enough for an assistant to discover and cite.

OWNED

02

Editorial & analyst authority

The outlets assistants trust on enterprise networking and security — Light Reading, Fierce, TechTarget, the analyst houses — and whose work they quote.

EARNED

03

Competitive context

How the sources assistants trust frame the field — which providers they treat as the authorities on fiber, edge and managed security.

CONTEXT

Assistants don't rank pages — they scan, select and quote. Discoverability is measurable, and it's a lever the comms team controls.

WHAT WE FOUND

ILLUSTRATIVE PREVIEW

Lumen Powers the AI Era. AI's Understanding Hasn't Caught Up.

We ran a small preview audit — 10 unbranded, category-level prompts × 5 assistants = 50 answers about enterprise fiber, edge and security.

Lumen is repositioning as the **connectivity backbone of the AI era** — the fiber behind the hyperscalers. In the assistants' own portrayal of the category, that story hasn't landed yet: **Lumen sits mid-pack, in a field where no one leads.**

~1 in 5

answers name Lumen in this sample — mid-pack, and thin across every assistant (no platform carries it)

26%

is the *ceiling* — the most-named brand tops out at roughly 1 in 4. No incumbent owns this category

2

categories collapsed into one — assistants blend network providers and security vendors, so the field itself is undefined

The signal isn't the number — it's the **shape of the field**. A 50-answer preview isn't a verdict, but it points to something unusual and valuable: a category the AI hasn't yet handed to anyone. The rest of this deck is about that opening — and how a full engagement would map and claim it.

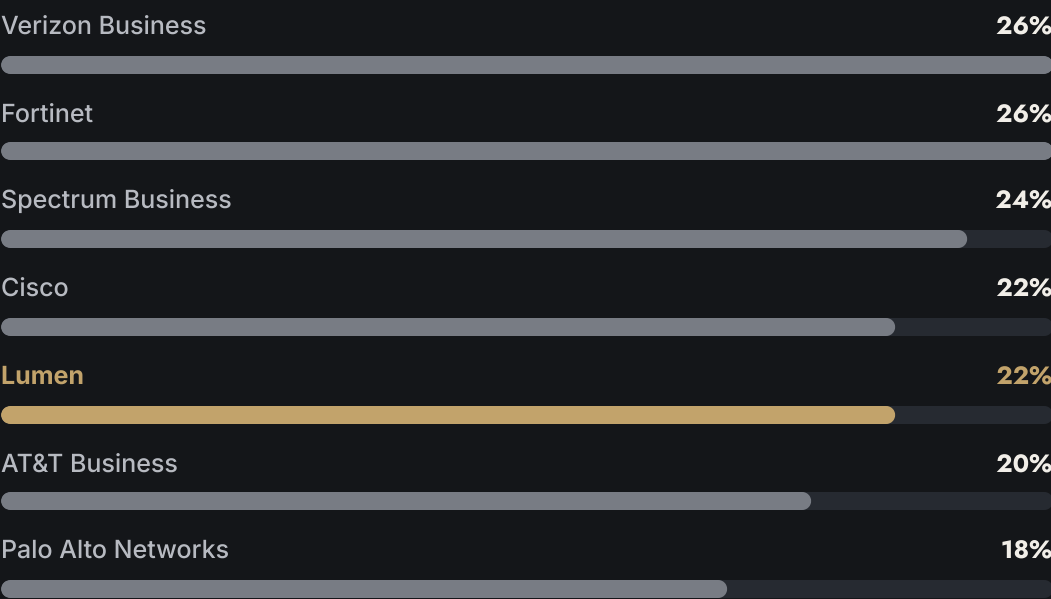
THE COMPETITIVE PICTURE

ILLUSTRATIVE PREVIEW

No One Owns This Category — the Leader Tops Out at 26%

Across 50 unbranded answers to *"who provides the best enterprise fiber, edge and security?"*, the assistants scattered their citations across a dozen names — telcos and security vendors alike. **The most-named brand appears in barely 1 in 4 answers.** Lumen sits in the pack, level with Cisco. A sample, not a census — but a consistent one across all five assistants.

SHARE OF VOICE · % OF 50 UNBRANDED CATEGORY ANSWERS



26%

the ceiling — no brand exceeds it. In most categories one name has already run away with the AI's pick

~4pts

separate 1st from Lumen — the whole field is bunched, and nobody is entrenched

Wide open

a rare, time-sensitive opening — the category is still there to be defined

THE EARLY SIGNAL

The interesting finding isn't Lumen's rank — it's that **there is no leader to unseat.** In a category this unformed, the brand that defines it in the AI's mind can claim it. **Worth testing at full scale — but the opening is real.**

Illustrative · drawn from the Lumen preview dashboard; citation counts shown as share of the 50-answer sample. Directional, not a census — a full engagement runs 100+ prompts.

WHY IT MATTERS

Most Categories Already Have an AI Incumbent. This One Doesn't.

Run this same method on most B2B categories and one name has already become the AI's default — entrenched, cited first, hard to dislodge. Enterprise fiber-edge-security is the exception: **the field is bunched under a 26% ceiling, with no brand the assistants reliably reach for.** That is unusual, and it favors whoever moves first.

The usual pattern

In observability, CRM, cloud and most mature categories, a single brand is named in **60–90% of answers** — the AI has already picked a favorite, and challengers spend years and budgets clawing back share.

Lumen's category

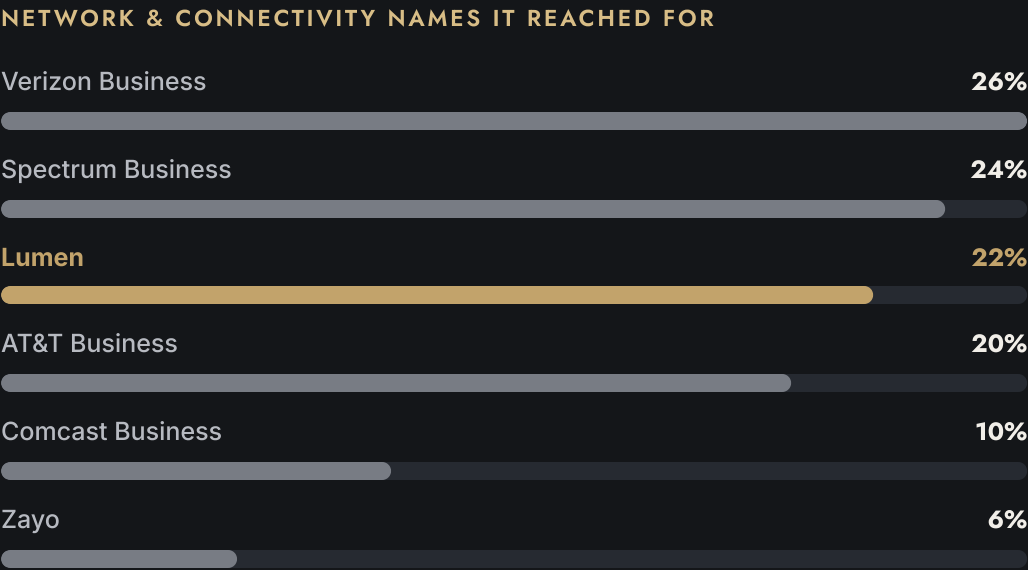
No brand tops ~26%. The AI hasn't committed. For a company already making the boldest infrastructure bet in the sector — the fiber backbone of the AI era — that is an opening to **define the category rather than fight for a slice of it.**

This is the finding a mention count can't give you: not "you rank 5th," but "**the category is unclaimed, and here is the window to claim it.**" That is a positioning question — exactly what a consultative take is for.

WHAT DEEPER ANALYSIS SURFACES ILLUSTRATIVE

The Assistants Can't Decide What This Category Even Is

Look at who the assistants named and a second finding appears: they mix two different kinds of company in the same breath — **network providers and security vendors**. The "fiber + edge + security" convergence Lumen sells isn't yet a coherent category in the AI's mind. It's contested territory, and definition is up for grabs.



WHY IT'S AN OPENING

Lumen sells the **convergence** — fiber, edge and security as one fabric — which is exactly the story the assistants haven't yet organized. **Whoever gives the AI that framing, with the sources to back it, defines the category.**

A SaaS dashboard would report these as one flat ranking. Studying the **actual answers** shows the category is fracturing along an old boundary Lumen is built to erase — the kind of strategic take that only comes from interpretation.

THE DIAGNOSIS

Our Take: A Narrative Gap, Not a Substance One

Lumen is making one of the most consequential infrastructure bets in the industry — the fiber and connectivity behind the AI buildout. The preview suggests that story isn't yet reaching the assistants in a form they can attribute to Lumen and repeat. A fuller audit would confirm where, source by source.

WHY ASSISTANTS MAY NOT BE CONNECTING IT

- The AI-backbone story may live in **press releases and investor decks** more than in the quotable, category-level content assistants pull from
- The category questions buyers ask (*"best enterprise fiber + security provider"*) aren't yet **tied to Lumen's narrative** in the sources assistants trust
- The **convergence positioning** is ahead of how the trade press and the assistants have organized the category

WHY THAT'S AN OPPORTUNITY

- It's a **fixable communications problem** — the assets and the story already exist; the work is surfacing and structuring them
- The comms team already **owns the channel** — the newsroom, the thought leadership, the earned relationships
- Progress is **measurable** — the same audit, re-run, shows the number move against a defined category

Lumen is doing the work of the decade. This is about making sure the assistants — and the buyers and reporters they brief — can **find it, attribute it to Lumen, and repeat it.**

WHY INNATE

Software Monitors. We Interpret.

Self-service tools can tell you whether you were mentioned. They can't tell you that the category has no owner, that it's fracturing along a network-vs-security line, or which of Lumen's stories to put in front of the assistants first. Our take comes from a person, not a score.

SAAS DASHBOARDS

Monitor

- Rankings by raw mention count
- Generic, off-the-shelf prompt libraries
- A list of top sources, without strategy
- A visibility score with no "so what"

INNATE · CONSULTATIVE INTELLIGENCE

Interpret

- **Absent, present, or quoted-first?** — prominence, not just presence
- Prompts modeled on how Lumen's buyers, analysts and reporters actually ask
- Sources correlated with **wins vs. losses** — owned briefs and earned openings
- 20 years of comms judgment interpreting the actual answers

ENGAGEMENT

How We Work

Bespoke from the first step. Every prompt is modeled on how Lumen's audiences actually ask — and reviewed with you before testing.

I

Business brief

Align on priorities — the category story, audiences (buyers, analysts, media, talent) and the competitive set.

II

Prompt generation

100 audience-modeled prompts — branded and unbranded — for your review and approval.

III

Data collection

Run across your chosen 5–10 AI assistants — ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Gemini, Claude, Perplexity, Grok — via API; every response and citation captured in full.

IV

Analysis

Presence vs. prominence, owned vs. earned classification, competitive patterns — interpreted by a human.

V

Presentation

Executive-ready report plus a live walkthrough with prioritized owned & earned recommendations.

100 prompts × your chosen 5–10 assistants = 500–1,000 query-runs per cycle, every one with full citation extraction.

ENGAGEMENT MODEL

Three Tiers — Take What You Need

The audit measures and recommends at a high level. The roadmap turns those findings into specific, page-level actions on Lumen's owned and earned channels. Execution implements them.

01	Citation Intelligence — the audit & report The measurement plus high-level recommendations . 5–10 AI assistants, 100 bespoke prompts each cycle (500–1,000 query-runs/mo); every citation classified owned vs. earned; month-over-month trends; executive briefing.	\$5-10k _{/mo}
02	Strategy Roadmap — the action plan The playbook behind the findings — a multi-page action memo (a prior client's ran 32 pages): how to define and surface the category story, page-level copy & FAQ for the newsroom and thought leadership, and an outlet-by-outlet earned plan.	+\$10k _{/roadmap}
03	Execution Ongoing consultation · owned-content development — surfacing and structuring Lumen's story for assistants · technical implementation with your team · press-release & pitch development · iterative optimization.	\$15k+ _{/mo}

Audit + roadmap together: \$15–20k/mo. Citation Intelligence scales \$1k per AI assistant — 5 / 500 query-runs at \$5k, up to 10 / 1,000 at \$10k; each roadmap is +\$10k.

Modular — run one tier or all three **Wraps around** your existing tools and agencies — the monitoring dashboards, media databases and Copilot stack — proves lift, doesn't replace them

Bespoke — no template reports

THE RETAINER IN PRACTICE

What the First Few Months Look Like

The monthly program is the point — a trend line only exists if you measure the same way over time. The measurement backbone stays constant; each month you aim it at a different question — and act on it. A sample cadence:

EVERY CYCLE	The constant — repeatable measurement Re-run the same prompts every month, every citation classified owned vs. earned — an apples-to-apples trend line you can defend to executives.
MONTH 1	Owned-media baseline on your thought-leadership pillars Set the baseline now — before the technical fixes land — on the pillars the blog is pivoting toward, so you can attribute and merchandise the lift as discoverability improves. Narrow and pillar-led, not boiling the ocean.
MONTH 2	Define the category & the AI-infrastructure story Map the fiber-edge-security convergence, see whether Lumen gets credit for powering the AI era, and target the sources that shape the answer in a category no one yet owns.
MONTH 3	Executive & talent visibility How assistants portray Lumen's leaders and the transformation story — a direct input to the media-training practice and the employer narrative.

A sample cadence — **you choose each month's focus**. Same retainer, a new lens; the trend line compounds.

WHERE WE'D START · THE OWNED-MEDIA BASELINE

Set the Owned-Media Baseline Now, Before the Fixes Land.

One focused first step, exactly where you're headed: baseline how discoverable and quotable Lumen's owned content is, measured **now, before the technical improvements roll out** — so you can attribute and track the lift.

From there, the same measurement re-run each month becomes a defensible trend line — 100 prompts across up to 10 of your chosen assistants (Microsoft Copilot included), tailored to Lumen and reviewed by a human every time. The sample in this deck is the illustrative 50-answer free read; the engagement is 20X larger with the consultative layer on top. Two case studies follow.

APPENDIX · CASE STUDY

Bain Capital Ventures: Owned Content to Displace the Listicles

BCV was absent from 82% of organic VC queries. A deep dive on every cited source found why — and the fix was an owned-content play.

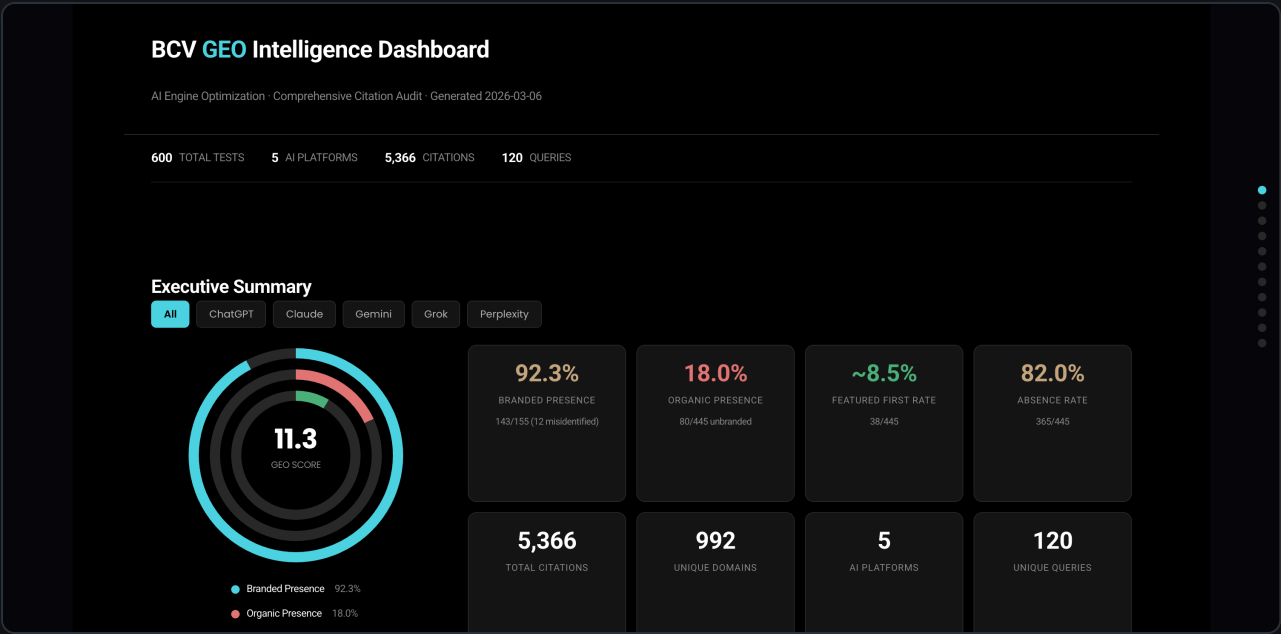
84 · 69

84 "quasi-editorial" pages — directories, listicles, roundups — were among AI's most-cited sources. BCV was **absent from 69 of them** while competitors were named.

25 vs 171

BCV's own site appeared in just **25 winning answers vs a16z's 171**. The move: publish BCV's own authoritative answers to the same founder questions — a credible **owned** source for the assistants to cite.

A tiered plan mapping every gap and the owned content to displace it — source-level intel a SaaS dashboard can't produce. Live dashboard → innatec3.com/bain



APPENDIX · CASE STUDY

Palisociety: Owned Content, Measured Uplift

A Marriott-affiliated boutique luxury hotel collection came to us for a baseline audit, then a roadmap that was **largely owned-media work**: exact copy changes and AI-optimized content for each property's own site — the same play Lumen's newsroom would run.

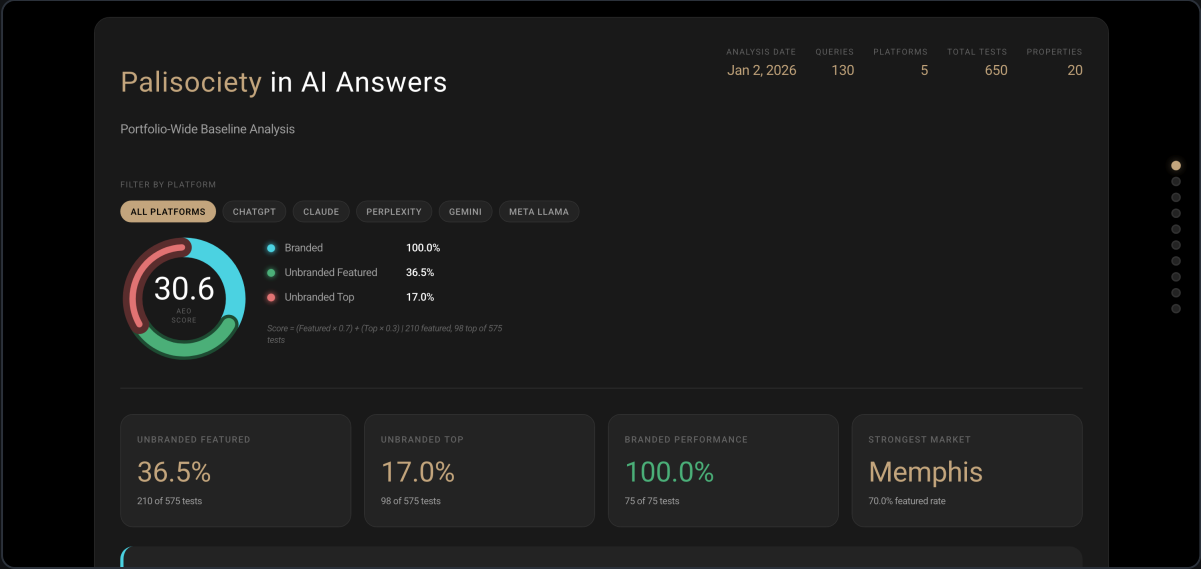
33% → 42%

Re-tested four months later on the newest models, AI **mention rate climbed +8 points** — top recommendations ~25% more often. One market, **Albuquerque**, jumped 35% → 75%.

Owned x2

Own-site citations doubled — the direct result of the owned-content roadmap. Earned moved too, and we could see which lever did what. Measured, attributable, repeatable.

Owned-content work, done consultatively — exact copy, per property, through the client's own review — and measured: **+8 points**. Live dashboard → innatec3.com/palisociety



APPENDIX · THE SAMPLE

The 10 Prompts Behind the Preview

Every prompt was unbranded and category-level — no brand names — so the results reflect organic consumption, not prompted recall. A full engagement runs 100+ prompts, reviewed and approved with you before testing.

ENTERPRISE FIBER, EDGE & SECURITY LENS

- 01

What are the best fiber networking solutions for large enterprises in 2026?
- 02

How do I choose between edge cloud and traditional cloud infrastructure for my business?
- 03

What do experts recommend for enterprise-grade network security and connectivity this year?
- 04

Which companies provide end-to-end fiber networking and security services for mid-to-large businesses?
- 05

What is the latest thinking on combining edge computing and private fiber for enterprise performance?
- 06

How are businesses reducing latency and improving reliability with edge cloud networking?
- 07

What should I look for in an enterprise technology provider offering fiber, cloud and cybersecurity together?
- 08

Most trusted providers of managed network and security services for enterprise companies right now?
- 09

How does edge cloud connectivity help with real-time data processing for distributed enterprise locations?
- 10

What are the current pricing and contract considerations for enterprise fiber and managed security services?